



UNIVERSITÄT
LEIPZIG

Asymmetric Numeral System

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Outline

1. Introduction
2. Entropy Coding
3. Asymmetric Numeral System
4. rANS
5. Streaming-rANS
6. Summary
7. Reference

Introduction

Introduction

- Hi there, this is a self inspired latex beamer template for Leipzig university.

Entropy Coding

Entropy Coding

- The theoretical limit of compression is given by Shannon entropy, which measures the minimum average number of bits needed to encode a symbol from a data source.
- Lossless compression algorithms aim to approach this limit but cannot go below it.
- The entropy depends on the probability distribution of the symbols, with more skewed distributions being more compressible.
- Shannon Entropy ^[1]

$$H(X) = - \sum_{i=1}^n p(x_i) \log_2 p(x_i)$$

- Shannon's Source Coding Theorem ^[1]

Asymmetric Numeral System

Motivation

ANS combines the compression ratio of arithmetic coding (which uses a nearly accurate probability distribution), with a processing cost similar to that of Huffman coding ^[4].

Basic Idea

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- Symmetric or Asymmetric
- rANS and tANS

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- the function that determines the split of the $\mathbb{N}$ subsets corresponding to different symbols [1]

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- the function that determines the split of the $\mathbb{N}$ subsets corresponding to different symbols [1]
- $\bar{s} : \mathbb{N} \rightarrow \mathcal{A}, \bar{s}(x) = \text{mod}(x, b) = s$
- In the standard binary system example: $\bar{s}(x) = \text{mod}(x, 2)$
e.g. splits natural numbers into subsets of even/odd numbers [2]

Symbol spread function (Exa. 1)

$$S = \{0, 1\}$$

Exa. 1: Standard Binary System

N	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18
s=0																			
s=1																			

Fig.1

Symbol spread function (Exa. 2)

$$\mathbf{S} = \{0, 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, 6, 7, 8, 9\}$$

$$x' = 10x + s$$

$\mathbb{N}$	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18	19	20	202	2025
$s=0$																							
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$s=4$																						...	...
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Fig.2

Representation of information (Exa. 2)

- a finite sequence of symbols/digits:

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- the sequence of symbols/digits to be encoded:

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- How can we represent this sequence as a single number?
- The easiest way is to concatenate the symbols/digits:

$$x_{out} = 2025$$

Representation of Information (Exa. 2)

- encoding the sequence of digits (2,0,2,5,1,8)

$$x_{\text{init}} = 0$$

$$x_1 = x_{\text{init}} \times 10 + 2 = 2$$

$$x_2 = x_1 \times 10 + 0 = 20$$

$$x_3 = x_2 \times 10 + 2 = 202$$

$$x_{\text{out}} = x_3 \times 10 + 5 = 2025$$

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- x' is the x -th appearance of symbol s

$$x' = C(s, x) = x \cdot 10 + s$$

Representation of Information (Exa. 2)

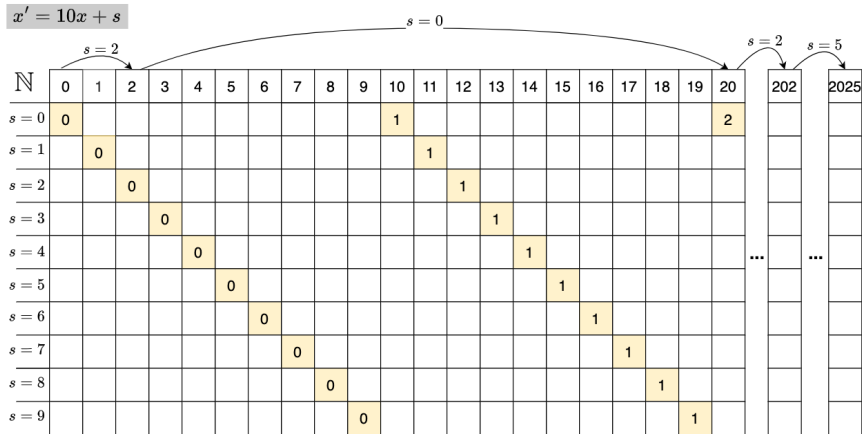


Fig.3

Representation of Information (Exa. 1)

Exa. 1: Standard Binary System

$X' = 2X + s$

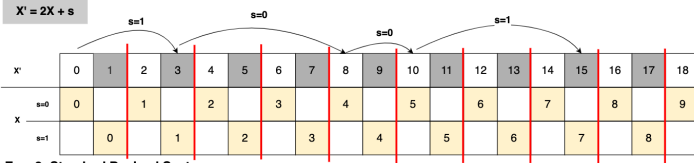
$s=1$ $s=0$ $s=0$ $s=1$

x'	0	1	2	3	4	5	6	7	8	9	10	11	12	13	14	15	16	17	18
x $s=0$	0		1		2		3		4		5		6		7		8		9
$s=1$		0		1		2		3		4		5		6		7		8	

Fig.4

Asymmetric Numeral System | Symmetric or Asymmetric |

Exa. 1: Standard Binary System



Exa. 2: Standard Decimal System

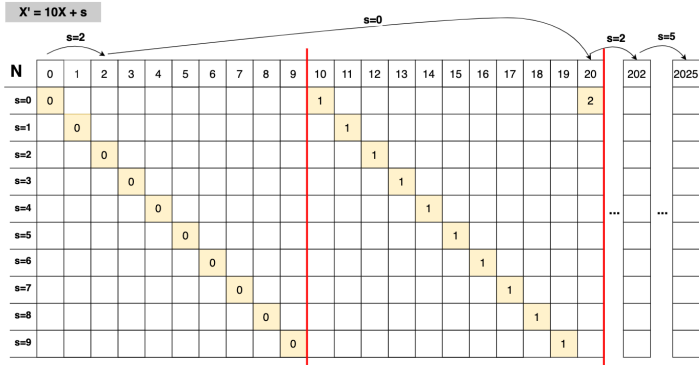


Fig.6

Exa. 3: Asymmetric Binary System

- Let $\mathcal{A} = \{0, 1\}$
- $Pr(0) = 1/4, Pr(1) = 3/4$

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- $x' = C(s, x) \approx x/p_s$

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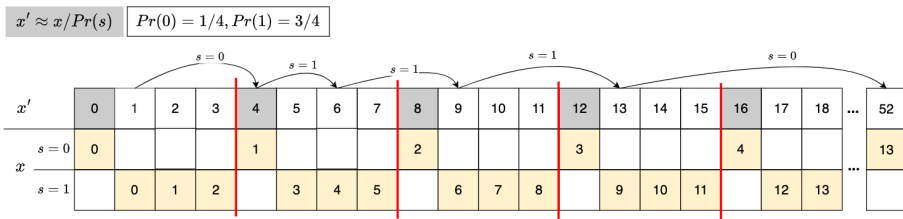


Fig.7

We refine even/odd number by changing their densities

Symmetric or Asymmetric

- Symmetric: uniform distribution
- Asymmetric: non-uniform distribution

tANS

— d

Performance

— f

rANS

rANS

- "r" = "range": similar to range coding (RC)
- symbol spread function
- representation of information
- asymmetric

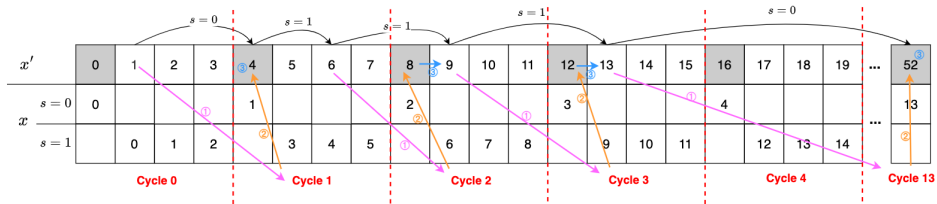
Exa.3

How to encode 101110? What is the encoding function $C(s, x)$?

$$x' = C(s, x) \approx x/p_s$$

$$x' \approx x / \text{Pr}(s)$$

$$\text{Pr}(0) = 1/4, \text{Pr}(1) = 3/4$$



Given current state x and next symbol s . How to find next state x' , which is the x -th appearance of symbol s ?

	$s = 0$	$s = 1$	0 and 1
Step ①: Find cycle number k	$k = \lfloor x/1 \rfloor = x$	$k = \lfloor x/3 \rfloor$	$k = \lfloor x/F_s \rfloor$
Step ②: Navigate to the beginning (first number) of that cycle	$4 \cdot k$	$4 \cdot k$	$m \cdot k$ m : size of the cycle
Step ③: Find the position of the symbol s in that cycle	part 1: first of one + 0	part 1: + $\text{mod}(x, 3)$	part 1: + $\text{mod}(x, F_s)$
- part 1: position of the symbol s in the sequence of the same symbol - part 2: how many other symbols before the symbol s	part 2: no other symbols + 0	part 2: only one other symbol (0) and with one of that symbol in one cycle + 1	part 2: only one other symbol (0) and with one of that symbol in one cycle + c_s
	$x' = 4 \cdot x$	$x' = 4 \cdot \lfloor x/3 \rfloor + \text{mod}(x, 3) + 1$	$x' = m \cdot \lfloor x/F_s \rfloor + \text{mod}(x, F_s) + c_s$

$$x' = C(s, x) = m \cdot \lfloor x/F_s \rfloor + \text{mod}(x, F_s) + c_s$$

Encoding Function (general):

$$x' = m \cdot \left\lfloor \frac{x}{F_s} \right\rfloor + \text{mod}(x, F_s) + c_s^{[5]}$$

- **Alphabet set:** $\mathcal{A} = \{a_1, a_2, \dots, a_k\}$
- **Absolute frequency of symbol s :** F_s
- **Total frequency:** $m = \sum_{i=1}^k F_i$
- **Probability of symbol s :** $p_s = \frac{F_s}{m}$
- **Cumulative frequency before s :** $c_s := F_0 + F_1 + \dots + F_{s-1}$

Encoding Function (binary):

$$x' = C(s, x) = \left\lfloor \frac{x}{F_s} \right\rfloor \ll n + \text{mod}(x, F_s) + c_s^{[2]}$$

- **Alphabet set:** $\mathcal{A} = \{a_1, a_2, \dots, a_k\}$
- **Absolute frequency of symbol s :** F_s
- **Total frequency:** $m = \sum_{i=1}^k F_i$
- **Probability of symbol s :** $p_s = \frac{F_s}{m}$
- **Cumulative frequency before s :** $c_s := F_0 + F_1 + \dots + F_{s-1}$
- $\ll n$ is a left shift by n bits

Decoding Function (binary):

$$D(x) = (s, F_s \cdot (x \gg n) + (x \& \textit{mask}) - c_s)^{[2]}$$

```
1  def rANS_encoder(symbol_counts, s_input):
2      # compute cumulative frequencies
3      cumul_counts = []
4      sum_counts = 0
5      for count in symbol_counts:
6          cumul_counts.append(sum_counts)
7          sum_counts += count
8      state = 0
9      output = []
10     for s in s_input:
11         Fs = symbol_counts[s]
12         Cs = cumul_counts[s]
13         state = (state // Fs) * sum_counts + Cs + (state % Fs)
14         output.append((s, state))
15
16     L_avg = math.ceil(math.log(state) / math.log(2.0)) / len(s_input)
17     return output, state, L_avg, entropy(symbol_counts)
```

Implemenation in Dash app with interactive visualization

```
1     def rANS_decoder(symbol_counts, num_symbols, state):
2         cumul_counts = [0] # Start with 0 as the first cumulative frequency
3         total_frequency = sum(symbol_counts)
4         for count in symbol_counts:
5             cumul_counts.append(cumul_counts[-1] + count)
6         def c_inv(y):
7             return bisect_right(cumul_counts, y) - 1
8         output = [] # List to store decoded symbols
9         for _ in range(num_symbols):
10             slot = state % total_frequency # Find the slot in the cumulative
11                 ↪ frequency range
12             s = c_inv(slot) # Get the symbol corresponding to the
13                 ↪ slot
14             Fs = symbol_counts[s] # Frequency of the symbol
15             Cs = cumul_counts[s] # Cumulative count of the symbol
16             output.append((s, state)) # Append decoded symbol to the
17                 ↪ output
18             state = (state // total_frequency) * Fs + (slot - Cs) # Update the
19                 ↪ state
20         return output, state
```

Streaming-rANS

Streaming-rANS

To avoid using large number arithmetic, in practice stream variants are used: which enforce by renormalization: sending the least significant bits of x to or from the bitstream (usually L and b are powers of 2). ^[4]

Example of the problem //TODO: add example

- ANS (Asymmetric Numeral Systems) uses a single integer x , known as the “state,” to represent the encoded data.
- Over time, as more symbols are encoded, the state x can grow arbitrarily large. This can lead to:
 - Overflow: If the value exceeds the precision limits of your system (e.g., a 32-bit or 64-bit register).
 - Inefficient Encoding: A larger x means you need more memory or bits to represent it.
- Using the Cfunction from the previous section to encode succeeding symbols, we can encode a sequence into a very large natural number x , which can be stored as a length $\lfloor \lg(x) \rfloor + 1$ bit sequence. [2]

$[L, H]$

- How to determine L and H?

$[L, H]$

- How to determine L and H?

-

$[L, H]$

- How to determine L and H?

-

-

Method 1 ^[2]: ANS encoding step of symbol s from state x ^[2]

```

while  $x > \max X[s]$  do                                     {fff}
    writeDigit(mod( $x, b$ ));  $x = \lfloor x/b \rfloor$                  {fff}
end while
 $x = C(s, x)$                                                 {fff}

```

Method 2: ANS decoding step from state x ^[2]

```

( $s, x$ ) =  $D(x)$                                                {fff}
useSymbol( $s$ )                                                {fff}
while  $x < L$  do                                           {fff}
     $x = b \cdot x + \text{readDigit}()$                            {fff}
end while

```

```
1     for i in range(10):  
2         print("Hello, World!")
```

Summary

Summary

- To summarize, this may help you to make a Leipzig university beamer presentation.

Reference

Reference

1. C. Shannon, "A mathematical theory of communication," The Bell System Technical Journal, vol. 27, pp. 379–423, 623–656, July, October
2. J. Duda, K. Tahboub, N. J. Gadgil and E. J. Delp, "The use of asymmetric numeral systems as an accurate replacement for Huffman coding," 2015 Picture Coding Symposium (PCS), Cairns, QLD, Australia, 2015, pp. 65-69, doi: 10.1109/PCS.2015.7170048.
3. J. Duda, "Asymmetric numeral systems: entropy coding combining speed of huffman coding with compression rate of arithmetic coding," arXiv:1311.2540.
4. Asymmetric numeral systems - Wikipedia
5. What is Asymmetric Numeral Systems? - Kedar Tatwawadi 1948.